Policy ID: POL-005
Title: Non-Retaliation and Confidentiality Policy
Version: 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026 | Owner: Ethics Office

SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT - fictional guidance created for a technical prototype. It does not describe any real organisation's policy.

Non-Retaliation and Confidentiality Policy

1. Purpose

This policy protects people who raise concerns in good faith and explains how information about concerns is kept confidential.

2. Protection from retaliation

The Organisation does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith or takes part in a review. Retaliation includes demotion, exclusion from work or meetings, threats, intimidation, and unfair performance reviews.

Protection applies even if the concern is not substantiated, as long as it was raised in good faith.

3. Reporting retaliation

Retaliation is treated as a separate concern. Report it as a new concern under POL-003 Raising a Concern, describing what happened and the approximate date or period.

4. Confidentiality of reports

The identity of a person who raises a concern is shared only with those who need to know it to handle the case. Case details are kept confidential and stored securely by the Ethics Office.

5. Anonymity

Reporters may choose to remain anonymous (see POL-003). An anonymous access key allows them to check case status and respond to questions without revealing their identity.

6. Limits on information shared

To protect the people involved, status updates may not include details of investigation findings or outcomes concerning other individuals.

7. Duties of people involved

Anyone who raises a concern or takes part in a review should keep the matter confidential and must not share case details with colleagues.